

BWS44601: Applied Research Skills

Synopsis:

This course provides students with guided opportunities to strengthen their research progress between the Research Proposal and Research Framework and Report phases. Emphasis is given to improving and updating their approved proposal, developing detailed research methodology, and initiating report writing with proper academic style and referencing. Through short seminars, peer discussions, and supervisor feedback, students will refine their research design, ensure methodological consistency, and enhance academic writing quality. This course bridges proposal planning with research implementation, fostering readiness for the final research phase.

Course Learning Outcomes (CLO):

At the end of this course, the students will be able to:

CLO1: Apply and integrate knowledge to solve real-world problems with critical self-reflection, and refine a research proposal based on feedback and methodological needs. (C4; LOD6; PLO4; SC7)

CLO2: Apply appropriate research methodology in developing the research framework. (P4; LOD11; PLO8)

CLO3: Produce a preliminary research report section with ethical considerations that demonstrates proper academic writing, citation, and structure. (A4; LOD16; PLO11)

Content Outline of the Course:

TOPIC 1: Refinement Summary

- 1.1 Overview of proposal feedback
- 1.2 Identifying improvements

TOPIC 2: Methodology Enhancement Workshop

- 2.1 Improvements to the research design and instruments
- 2.2 Explanation of alignment between objectives, research questions, and methods

TOPIC 3: Academic Writing Clinic

- 3.1 Structure of research chapters, paraphrasing, citation tools

TOPIC 4: Research Design Consistency Matrix

- 4.1 Alignment between objectives, research questions, variables, methods, and data requirements.

TOPIC 5: Preliminary Analysis Plan

- 5.1 Initial plan for data analysis
- 5.2 Sample tables/graphs using dummy data to illustrate expected outputs

TOPIC 6: Progress Seminar & Reflection

- 6.1 Presentation of progress and research readiness for next phase

Teaching Method: Final Year Project

Materials to deliver the course: Slide, Gantt charts and project scheduling tools, project work, practical session, case studies, meeting with university supervisor, seminar, etc.

Expected outcomes:

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to critically review and refine their approved research proposal to ensure clarity, coherence, and alignment with the intended research objectives and framework; develop a detailed, systematic, and methodologically sound research methodology appropriate to the study; ensure consistency between the research problem, objectives, methodology, and proposed analysis in preparation for research implementation; produce initial sections of a research report using proper academic writing conventions and correct referencing style; integrate constructive feedback from supervisors and peers to enhance research quality; and effectively communicate research progress in academic settings such as seminars and peer discussions using appropriate scholarly language.

Assessment method: Project / Industrial Product / Progress Report/ Demonstration / Project/ Progress Report.

Assessment

PLO4: Interpersonal Skill, **PLO8:** Leadership, Autonomy and Responsibility, **PLO11:** Ethics & Professionalism, **SC7:** Self Awareness Competency

Assessment	Assessor	CLO	PLO	Level	Assessment Tool	%
Continuous	University (SV)	CLO1	PLO4-SC7	C4	WBL Logbook- Progress Report	10
		CLO1	PLO4	C4	Project Refinement Report	20
		CLO2	PLO8	P4	Demonstration	10
		CLO3	PLO11	A4	Video Presentation	5
	Industry	CLO1	PLO4-SC7	C4	WBL Logbook Progress Report	25
		CLO2	PLO8	P4	Observation	30
Total						100